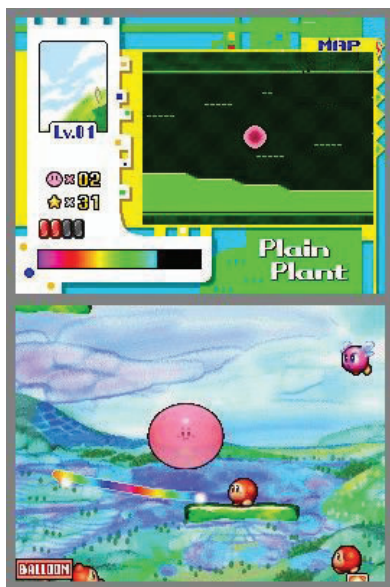




The level design is way more diverse than an average Mario palette. From beautiful hand crayon drawn outdoors and pencilled indoors to futuristic vector-like drawings, the levels are chirpy and well thought out, with traps laid out diabolically but not frustratingly.

The game also follows the classic line of putting a boss battle at the end of a level, giving old-school gamers a dose of the 'good old days'.

While the box art and the pink cute creature might fool you into avoiding this and going to pick up the terrifying Pokemon games, think again. Give this a whirl, you won't be disappointed.

3.5 What to Buy?

Just as in the case of video game consoles, handheld consoles have no clear winner. In fact, the two consoles are so vastly different that any comparison between them is almost ridiculous.

When you decide to buy a handheld, the first question to ask yourself would be: "What am I going to use it for?"

3.5.1 FOR MULTIMEDIA

As we have noted throughout this Fast Track, the PlayStation Portable is great as an all-round multimedia and gaming tool, while the Nintendo DS and even the DSi don't really offer much in this regard.

The PSP's large 4.3-inch LCD screen is great for watching movies while on the move, rendering crisp and clear pictures. The fact that it supports all the common formats for video playback, such as DivX, AVI, MPEG-4, etc. goes a long way to ensuring that almost anything you throw at it will perform well.

The sound quality is quite high too, as should be expected from the company that invented the Walkman! The device is great to use as your primary portable audio player, and the support for MP3 and AAC formats should cover the desires of most users.

For photo-viewing, the gizmo supports JPEG, GIF and PNG formats so that you can view all your pictures easily. The Go! Edit software will also allow users to manipulate and edit their images if they so desire.

The PSP also connects to the PlayStation 3, letting you transfer movies and